

CDSI 2026: Lesson 1

Name: _____

LEVEL 1: ENTER THE ARENA

What is Policy Debate?

- It is an academic _____ with rules!
- How many people are on a team? _____
- You are trying to win over the _____, who keeps score.
- Unlike arguing with a friend, debate requires

(research)

and has _____ limits.

Classroom Norms

- 🤝 _____ your opponent always.
- 🗣️ Never _____ a speech.
- 🔥 Try your _____ every round, even when it feels hard.
- 🛡️ Support your _____.

Choose Your Player

🟢 The Affirmative (Aff)

- **Goal:** Says "YES" to the _____ change.
- **Mindset:** Things need to be fixed to solve a big _____.
- **Action:** Presents a specific _____ to clear up the issue.

The Negative (Neg)

- **Goal:** Says _____ to the rule change.
- **Mindset:** Keep things exactly the _____!
- **Action:** Proves the Aff's idea is bad, costs too much, or causes new _____.

The Judge (The Decider)

- **Goal:** Listens fairly and signs a _____ to pick the winner.
- **Role:** You are trying to convince *them*, not the opposing team!
-  **Pro-Tip:** Make eye contact with the _____, not the other team!

LEVEL 2: CRAFTING YOUR ARGUMENT

The Argument Sandwich

You need all 3 items in your inventory to construct a winning argument!

-  **C** _____: Your big idea (The top bread).
-  **W** _____: Your reason or evidence (The filling).
-  **I** _____: Why it matters (The bottom bread).

⚠️ Inventory Check! ⚠️

- A claim without a warrant is just an

- A warrant without an impact is just a

🚀 Mini-Quest: Mars in a Box 🚀

Mission Briefing: You are going on a one-way trip to Mars. You can only bring ONE personal item that fits in a 2ft box. Defend your item below!

📦 **My Item:**

📦 **My Claim (Big Idea):** *I should bring my item because...*

🌿 **My Warrant (Reason / Evidence):** *This item is necessary/useful because...*

📦 **My Impact (Why it matters):** *This is critical for my survival/happiness on Mars because...*